

Europe on Microsoft, eventually, we will see this reaching worldwide including India.

Q. Is there any law in India that requires you to gradually shift the data here? Is there any timeline, etc, related to it?

A. Data sovereignty, of course, is a big challenge in the world. More and more governments are expecting data to get processed within their geographical boundaries. This was one of the key objectives we had when we partnered with Microsoft.

While there is no specific rule as such, the Indian government of course is doing its own due diligence around data privacy and data protection acts, etc. We believe that our partnership with Microsoft will automatically help us take care of the challenges.

Q. Can you give us a broad outline as to what are the different roles at the Bengaluru centre?

A. We set up the Bengaluru centre in 2012. And every year, we have been scaling the centre, getting deeper and deeper into the complex domain of travel. Our engineers are working on critical programs within the company. And so, primarily, it's a technology centre. Out of the 3000-odd engineers, around 65% are actually writing code, testing software, requirements, specifications, and so on.

Then we have a large vertical to manage and successfully run the platform after the software is ready for deployment. The platform that we run is SaaS-based and has many players and a worldwide customer base. It deals with extremely high volumes, even to the tune of 30,000-40,000 transactions a second. So, its software needs to function in high availability mode, even to a tune of 99.9999% availability uptime. So we have a large team here, that works with our other engineering centre to make sure that the platform

availability is at the highest level.

We do have other smaller teams that are into providing IT helpdesk and support services for our customers. The rest is customer support and corporate functions. Of course, we have a large corporate team. We have a security operation centre in Bengaluru, which manages to keep our platform secure from day-to-day threats. So, we have a security operations centre (SOC) here that protects the Amadeus platform worldwide.

Q. Are you hiring as of now? What is the current status of the resignation wave?

A. We do acknowledge that, in the technology industry, there is some turbulence going on. Different companies are looking at their investment strategies, etc. We are in an industry that is in recovery mode. And as I mentioned earlier, the need for innovation in this industry is at its highest. So, Amadeus continues to invest in the technology platform to transform the industry. We recently expanded to a new office in Pune, to tap into the rich talent that the market offers. Currently, we are looking to fill more than 100 roles by next year at the centre.

Q. Does it help the job applicants at Amadeus to have an open source contribution? How do the engineering leaders make sure that the keywords on their resumes have some real weight?

A. Oh, absolutely. When we are searching for engineers and talents, I'd say not only open source but we see if they have that technological, geeky frame of mind. Other things come out during the discussions and interviews. We have partners who constantly scout open source platforms to see the contributions. There are sophisticated hiring portals that have already done this kind of profiling when they source a candidate for us.

Q. Any technologies that you would suggest to professionals, especially developers, to hone their skills on, and some which are now of the past and they may forget about?

A. I never hazard the risk to say any technology is in the past. Because history tells us that any technology that gets developed, eventually lasts a long time. For example, you would think that mainframes are legacy as they were created 40-50 years back, and now, hardly anyone uses mainframes. But, if you do a survey in the industry, I'm sure there are many sectors that are still on the mainframes. The travel industry is on mainframes in many aspects. Amadeus is one of the first technology providers in the travel industry that got off mainframes and ran fully on open source mainframe systems. But there are many travel providers who are still running mainframes in their data centres. So, I never hazard the risk to say that any software has become redundant. For example, C++ still remains very popular and we leverage it vigorously.

But if you look to the future, Python is getting popular; streaming software like Kafka and sophisticated UI frameworks like React—these are software that we leverage heavily on our platform.

Q. What message would you convey to the open source community at large?

A. Again, we would be happy to welcome more and more engineers into the open source bandwagon and make sure that the solutions that we develop are sophisticated, supportable, secure, and take care of various security considerations across the world. So, the more the merrier. Working in the open source community provides unique opportunities to make a large impact in the technology ecosystem and I would recommend young engineers to pursue it. **END** 🐧